will be poorer, and more vulnerable to those looking to exploit their desperation and sell them into slavery.

If the fate of those who fled or were forced out of Rakhine has been grim, conditions for those left behind also worsened. The region subsequently had destructive monsoon rains connected with Cyclone Komen in mid-August, and this led to flooding of almost all the camps the Rohingyas are kept in and the destruction of what little goods and food they had stored.[116] Komen was not particularly destructive, and would normally have been seen as simply a particularly heavy storm within the normal weather patterns, but the non-existent infrastructure in the internal refugee camps left the Rohingyas very vulnerable to its effects. The authorities, naturally, continue to deny there is any problem:

> 'The camps are stable,' U Tin Maung Swe, a secretary for the Rakhine state government said. 'The people there are rich—they have land and they sell their crops on the market,' said the official, showing a booklet with projects such as an asphalt road and a school built with state money in the camps.[117]

The limited relief efforts of the provincial and state administration deliberately ignored the destruction of Rohingya villages and flooding in the camps.[118] Thus even as the political situation in Myanmar worsens and local politics in Rakhine falls into the hands of the Buddhist extremists, the Rohingyas are collectively losing what little communal wealth they have left.